

leaving others chronically dry. The 2026 budget addresses this structural imbalance through an interconnected series of river-linking projects of unprecedented scale.

The Wainganga-Nalganga project, sanctioned at ninety-four thousand nine hundred and sixty-eight crore rupees, will redirect surplus water from flood-prone regions toward drought-affected farmlands. The Damanganga-Vaitarna-Godavari link at thirteen thousand four hundred and ninety-seven crore, the Nar-Par Girna project at seven thousand four hundred and sixty-five crore, and the Damanganga-Ekdare-Godavari connection together form a hydraulic network that will fundamentally alter the water availability map of the state. Flood waters from the Krishna basin will be channelled to water-scarce zones in western Maharashtra and Marathwada — converting seasonal destruction into year-round agricultural opportunity.

Urban water infrastructure receives equal attention. A World Bank-supported programme of five thousand eight hundred and sixty crore rupees will deliver one hundred percent treatment and recycling of city wastewater across Maharashtra. Long-term targets — one hundred and thirty-five litres per capita per day in urban areas and fifty-five litres in rural areas by 2047 — are formally embedded in the budget framework. A State Water Information Centre in Nashik will provide real-time digital monitoring of water resources statewide.

Reflecting the government's forward-planning approach, drought preparedness measures against a possible El Niño in 2026 have already been built into the budget provisions.

An Agricultural Agenda Built on Relief, Reform and Technology

The Fadnavis government's approach to agriculture combines immediate financial support with long-term structural reform. The Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Farmers' Loan Waiver Scheme provides debt relief of up to two lakh rupees for eligible farmers, while a fifty-thousand-rupee incentive simultaneously rewards those who have maintained regular repayments — a design that balances relief with the promotion of credit discipline. Between June and October 2025, more than fifteen thousand crore rupees was already transferred directly into farmers' accounts.

The budget pairs this relief with a programme of agricultural modernisation. A New Natural Farming Mission will bring five lakh hectares under chemical-free cultivation. Four agricultural universities will establish Artificial Intelligence Innovation and Incubator Centres with the specific objective of reducing farm production costs by twenty-five percent. One crore thirty-one lakh digital farmer IDs are to be created by January 2026, now extended for the first time to tribal forest-farmers.

Energy access for farmers is addressed through the Solar Krishi Vahini Yojana 2.0, which targets sixteen thousand megawatts of solar capacity to provide daytime electricity to all agricultural pump sets by December 2026. Maharashtra already leads the country in solar agricultural pump deployment with six lakh sixty-three thousand installations. The Mukhyamantri Baliraja Free Power Scheme, with a twenty-thousand-crore provision for this year, ensures that electricity costs do not continue to erode farm income.

As Chief Minister Fadnavis told the assembly: "Jab iraada bana liya unchi udaan ka, phir dekhna fizool hai kad aasmaan ka". For Maharashtra's farmers, that sky is coming into clearer view than it has in a generation.

The Developed Maharashtra Budget 2026 is the product of a government that has consistently matched announcement with action. Under Devendra Fadnavis, Maharashtra is not waiting to arrive. It is already well on its way.

Budget at a Glance: Developed Maharashtra Budget 2026

Domain Key	Scheme / Initiative	Outlay / Target
Farmer Relief	Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Loan Waiver	Up to ₹2 lakh per farmer + ₹50,000 incentive
Farm Power	Mukhyamantri Baliraja Free Power Scheme	₹20,000 crore provision; ₹32,756 crore disbursed to date
Solar Farming	Solar Krishi Vahini Yojana 2.0	16,000 MW target; 6,63,324 pumps installed; No. 1 in India
Natural Farming	New Natural Farming Mission	5 lakh hectares under natural cultivation
Fisheries	Mukhyamantri Matsya Sampada Yojana	₹1,240 crore annually; 20,594 fishermen benefited
River Linking	Wainganga-Nalganga Project Damanganga-Vaitarna-GodavariLink Nar-Par Girna Link	₹94,968 crore ₹13,497 crore ₹7,465 crore
Urban Water	World Bank Urban Water and Sewerage Project	₹5,860 crore; 100% wastewater recycling
Industry	Gadchiroli Steel Hub Gems and Jewellery Policy Bamboo Value Chain	₹2,61,000 crore investment; 70,895 jobs ₹1 lakh crore investment; 5 lakh jobs ₹50,000 crore investment; 5 lakh jobs
Tech and Media	Media Tech and AVGC Hubs, Mumbai & Pune	$50 billion; 400 GCCs; 30 lakh jobs
Women	Lakhpati Didi Umeed Mall	27 lakh created; 25 lakh more in 2026-27 13 districts; women SHG marketplace
Youth	Startup and Unicorn Ecosystem	1.25 lakh entrepreneurs; 50,000 startups supported
Infrastructure	Metro Network Expansion Expressway Network Sea Bridges — Bandra-Versova-Bhayander	1,200 km statewide 6,000+ km ₹58,754 crore
Green Energy	Renewable Energy Investment	₹3 lakh crore; 50% green by 2029
Governance	New Government Posts	75,000 additional posts to be filled
Housing	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana	27.87 lakh sanctioned; 3.57 lakh completed

